Anyone can come up with some capital. But almost no one has the time. I know I don't. We're hustling to make a buck selling cars, making soap, or suing people. We're riveted on the next promotion, transfer, or raise. We work to pay off a new sailboat rather than to pile up enough dough to carry us through a start-up. At the end of the day we're worn out, exhausted by constant pressure. Our minds aren't likely to spark with the creativity one needs to start a potential billion-dollar business."

Chambers has hit on a paradox. For most of us, working keeps us from becoming rich. When we work we spend time and energy on defined tasks. For that effort we can make $50,000 or $200,000 or more each year. But to become very rich one needs to work not on defined tasks but on new concepts. H. Ross Perot, Sam Walton, Carl Icahn, and Peter Ueberroth made their fortunes by looking at products and markets in new, creative ways. They became very rich by observing and imagining.

It takes luck as well as creativity and imagination to make a billion dollars. But to get yourself into a position to make "big" money, you probably need to stop chasing after "little" money.

Perhaps the best example of what I'm talking about is Joseph P. Kennedy, Sr., the president's father. In the 1920s Kennedy amassed a tidy sum running a Boston bank, mixing in show business, and playing the stock market. In 1929 he had the foresight, or luck, to sell out before the Depression wiped out paper gains. In 1934 he became the first chairman of the SEC and, later, ambassador to the Court of St. James.

At the end of World War II, Mr. Kennedy was out of both business and politics. He retired to mansions in New York, Cape Cod, and Palm Beach. According to *The Founding Father,* by Richard J. Whalen, Kennedy's "life in Florida was pleasant and well ordered. On a typical day, he awoke about seven, ate breakfast in his room, and read his mail and several newspapers before going downstairs around nine-thirty.